

**Question:**  
A 50-year-old man presents to the emergency department complaining of chest pain and drooling that started immediately after eating a steak. His past medical history is significant for lye ingestion 5 years ago during a suicidal attempt. He also suffers from hypertension and diabetes mellitus, type 2. He takes fluoxetine, lisinopril, and metformin every day. He also regularly sees a counselor to cope with his previous suicide attempt. Both of his parents are still alive and in good health. His heart rate is 96/min, temperature is 36.7°C (98.1°F). On physical examination, the patient can talk normally and breaths without effort. He is drooling. The chest pain is vague and constant. A chest X-ray shows no subcutaneous emphysema. An endoscopy confirms the presence of a retained bolus of meat 24 cm beyond the incisors where a stricture is identified. The bolus is removed and the stricture is dilated. Which of the following anatomic spaces contains the stricture? Answer Choices: A. The superior mediastinum B. The diaphragm C. The posterior mediastinum D. The epigastrium

**Reasoning + Answer:**

<think> The assistant is thinking about the fact that the patient has a history of lye ingestion, which can cause a stricture in the esophagus. The stricture is likely to be caused by the scar tissue that forms as a result of the lye ingestion. The stricture can be located in any part of the esophagus, but it is most commonly found in the lower esophagus. The assistant is also thinking about the fact that the patient has been experiencing chest pain and drooling after eating a steak, which suggests that the stricture may be causing a blockage in the esophagus. The assistant is considering the fact that the endoscopy has confirmed the presence of a retained bolus of meat 24 cm beyond the incisors, which suggests that the stricture is located in the lower esophagus. </think> <answer> D. The epigastrium </answer>

Reward score

1.0

0.5

0.0

-0.5

-1.0

-1.5